

A simpler way to growth.

AI-assisted operations for a premium independent hair salon in Berlin.

CONTEXT

Meet the client

THE BUSINESS

- Independent, appointment-only hair salon in Prenzlauer Berg, Berlin
- High-end positioning: €90–115 cuts, €145–275 color services
- 2 owner-operators, 2 chair renters, **zero employees**
- 4 chairs, open Tue–Sat, reliably booked ~1 week ahead
- 5-star Google rating (29 reviews); combined ~2.8k Instagram followers

WHAT WE WANT TO SOLVE FOR

Capture every booking

Protect booked chair-time

Grow client lifetime value

THE FOUNDER'S FEAR

“What even is the AI? How would I sign up?”

Berlin Market Size

Total market in Berlin, narrowed down to the number of clients the salon actually needs to reach a strong 82% chair utilization rate.



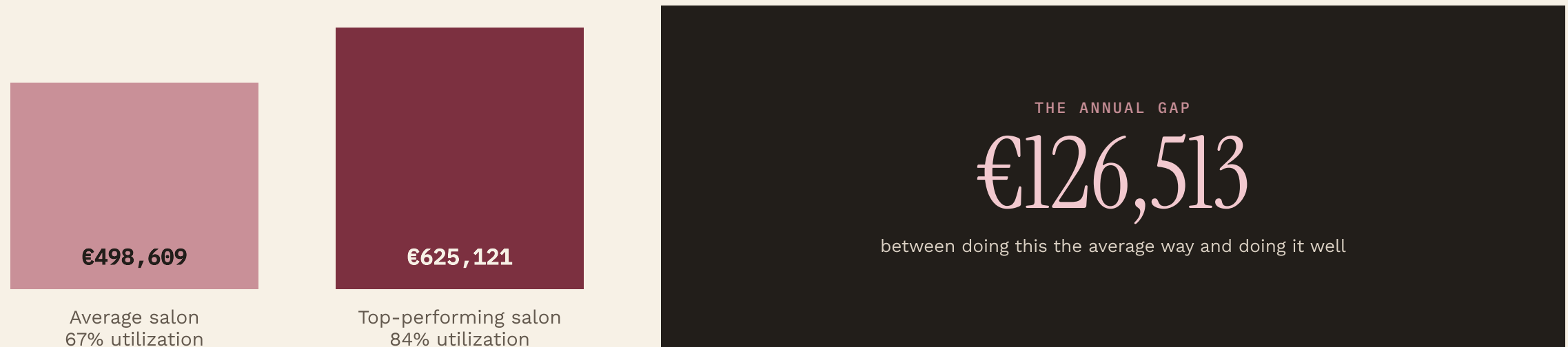
The salon needs 1,700 to 2,300 active clients, not a share of Berlin's 3.7 million residents.

Chair utilization is the share of available chair-hours that are actually booked and paid. 82% sits between the industry average (67%) and top-performing salons (84%).

WHAT THIS IS WORTH

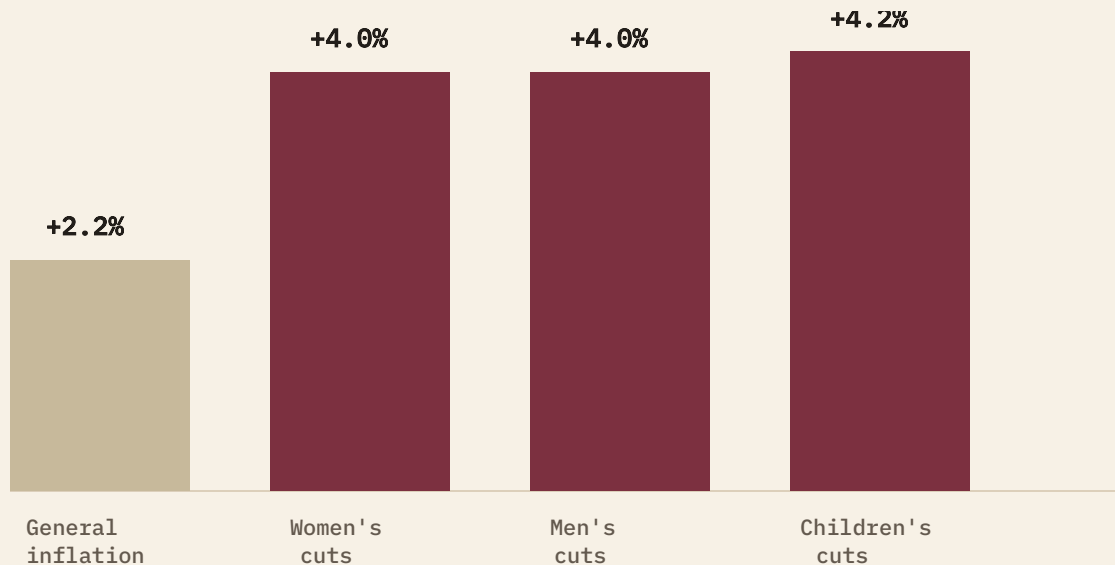
Salon Utilization Opportunity

Estimated yearly revenue for the salon at average vs. top-performing chair utilization, using the salon's own €102/hour average cut price and 152 chair-hours/week.



Note: this is a planning estimate, not a measured number. It uses one flat rate across all 4 chairs as a simplification, 2 of the salon's chairs are rented and priced independently by the renters. The real baseline still needs to be measured.

Haircuts are outpacing inflation

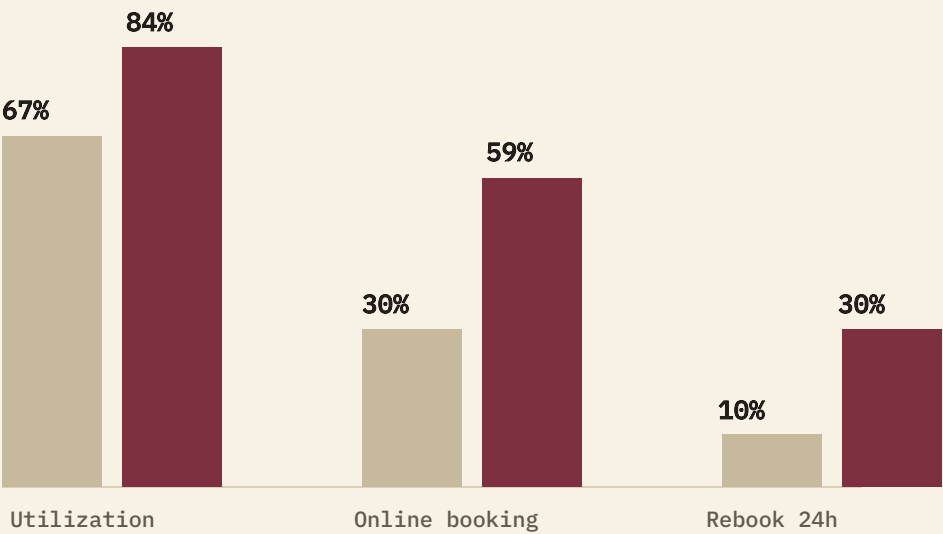


WHY THIS MATTERS

In 2024, German haircut prices rose **4.0–4.2%**, nearly double the country's general inflation rate of 2.2%. This confirms what the briefing already suggested (7.2–7.6% price growth in 2023) and indicates real willingness to pay more in this segment.

Every point of price growth raises the cost of an empty chair. Protecting booked hours, not just filling them, is worth more every year.

The gap between average and top performers



Average Top performer

WHY THIS MATTERS

Even without this salon's own baseline yet, industry benchmarks show top-performing salons out-executing the average by double digits on exactly the levers our three use cases target: keeping chairs full, capturing bookings directly, and getting clients rebooked before they leave.

8%

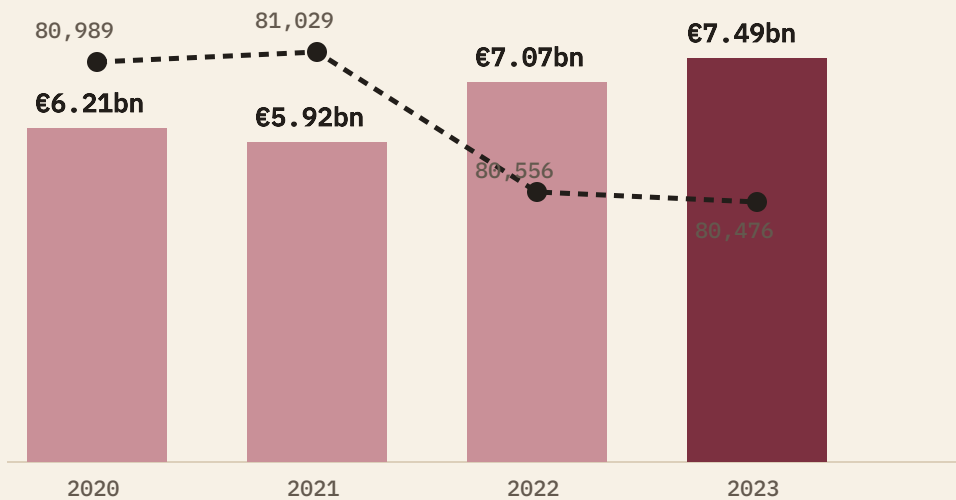
Avg. cancellation rate

3%

Avg. no-show rate

Benchmarks on this slide are from Zenoti's 2025 platform data (US/Canada, 30,000+ businesses), directional, not Germany-specific. Used to illustrate that a gap exists in the industry.

Fewer Salons, More Revenue



■ Sector revenue — Salon count

WHY THIS MATTERS

From 2020 to 2023, the number of registered salons in Germany kept drifting down, while sector revenue climbed back up. Both trends, shown together.

The market isn't growing by adding salons, it's consolidating value into fewer, more productive locations.

Three use cases, one operating logic

01

AI Booking & Inquiry Assistant

PROBLEM

Calls, WhatsApp, email, and DMs bypass Acuity. The owner personally triages every one.

SOLUTION

A conversational assistant checks real Acuity availability and responds directly, confirms, redirects, or explains when full.

Fit: No new hires, no complex integration. Proportionate to a 4-chair shop.

02

No-Show & Cancellation Recovery

PROBLEM

No-shows happen weekly to bi-weekly. The €50 deposit covers the fee, not the lost chair-time.

SOLUTION

Automated pre-appointment reminders, plus a waitlist that's pinged the moment a slot opens.

Fit: Fully automatable; recovers revenue that's currently just lost.

03

Retention & Re-Engagement

PROBLEM

Retail is light and inconsistent despite an upscale, exclusive product line.

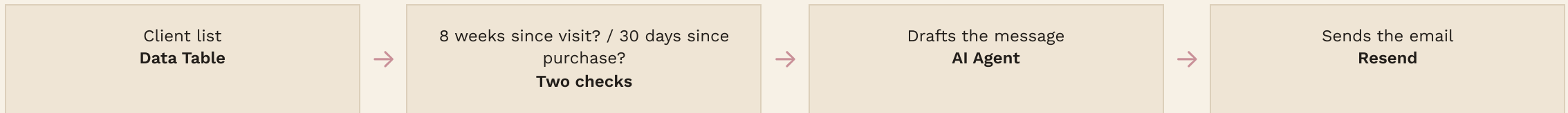
SOLUTION

Rebooking nudges, purchase-cadence reorder reminders, and simple rule-based product recommendations.

Fit: Turns existing loyalty into proactive revenue. No new staff or sales process.

Retention & Re-Engagement, Built and Tested

THE WORKFLOW (N8N)



5 test clients, mixed on purpose. 3 needed a rebooking nudge, 3 needed a reorder reminder, 1 needed both, 1 needed neither, and correctly got nothing.

"Hi Lukas! Just a friendly reminder that you might be running low on your styling cream..."

LANGSMITH MONITORING

12

traces logged

0%

error rate

\$0.01

total cost

Every AI-drafted message is logged and reviewable, this is what "the AI can be observed" looks like in practice, not just a claim.

What's demo vs. production: test data used fake purchase history and one test inbox instead of real clients. Monitoring of logs will be used to surface any issues in the message automation workflow.

THE ASK

Cost, Timeline, and the Next Step

€9,450

One-time build for all 3 use cases (10.5 consultant days × €900/day)

4 weeks

Kickoff to a working MVP covering all 3 use cases

€50–140_{/mo}

Ongoing tools (n8n, Twilio, LLM API), paid directly by the salon

KEY ASSUMPTIONS

€900/day, our rate for automation and AI consulting work. The salon owns every tool account, we get admin access to configure them. Full breakdown in *cost_estimation/cost_analysis.md*.

OPTIONAL ONGOING SUPPORT

A monthly retainer (flat or 10–15% of tool spend) or pay-as-you-go at €120/hour, no commitment either way.

NEXT STEPS

- 1 Confirm which use case(s) to prioritize
- 2 Sign off on scope, cost, and timeline
- 3 Grant access to Acuity and the email/SMS provider
- 4 Kick off discovery, Week 1